LET'S FIX

A Guide On Godly Relationships

Written By

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DEDICATION

In a world where love often feels elusive and fragile, it's easy to see why some may consider giving up on it altogether. The concept of love has been exploited, making it difficult to define the best experience of it. Every day, people walk away from love, uncertain of its worth.

To those on the brink of surrender, remember that love's true essence transcends fleeting disappointments and heartaches. It perseveres, evolves, and ultimately transforms us in ways we could never imagine. As Charles Orlando once said, *"You cannot just give up on someone because the situation is not ideal. Great relationships aren't great because they have no problems. They are great because both people care enough about each other to find a way to make it work."*

I dedicate this book to everyone who feels like love was never meant for them, to those standing at the edge of giving up. Keep the faith—don't give up just yet. Heartbreaks are not the end; they are lessons, imparting wisdom through experience.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

My deepest gratitude goes to God Almighty. He has always revealed Himself in my life, guiding me through every step. Most of all, I thank Him for granting me the courage and wisdom to write this book. It is only by His might and power that all things are accomplished. He has stood by me, and it is through His knowledge that I write today. I am forever grateful.

I extend my heartfelt thanks to my dear friend, Bodric Mulenga, who introduced me to the Christian life that I cherish today. He showed me that Christianity is more than just attending church on Sundays, it is a way of life. I am also deeply grateful to Mrs. Anita Mwape, who always took the time to teach me more about faith. Her guidance and support have played a significant role in shaping me into the woman I am today.

To all those I have dated before, thank you for being part of my journey and helping me discover myself. I continue to pray for you and wish you all find the right partner and enjoy a life of prosperity.

A special thank you to Kapungwe Chama, Sir Makono Namangolwa, Sir Dunda Mwape, Kingford Chisenga, Martha Chitoshi, Harriet Chisembe, Luse Moonga, and

everyone who stood by me in times of difficulty. You helped me heal from pain and darkness, illuminating my world when I needed it most. You saw the jewel within me when I struggled to see it myself. May God richly bless you all.

ENDORSEMENT MESSAGES

Nelson Longesha – Award-Winning Author
Author of The Unspoken Side of Modern Dating
Author of How to Handle a Breakup Like a Boss

Someone once told me that our parents' generation managed to sustain relationships because they *did not throw away what could be fixed.* That statement resonates deeply, as we live in a time when many seem to undervalue relationships and the effort needed to nurture them.

"Let's Fix" is a book filled with practical principles to help you strengthen and refine the quality of your relationships. While you don't need everyone in your life, not everyone is replaceable. Some relationships are worth defending and working to improve.

Sinovia Mulenga displays remarkable vulnerability, inviting the reader into her journey—highlighting mistakes, lessons, and personal growth. This is a must-read for anyone determined to cultivate *"wow-kind"* relationships.

Solomon Arthur Chenga
ACTS29 Koinonia Chairperson

Reading this book gave me a renewed sense of meaning, self-worth, and a deeper understanding of Godly relationships. Overcoming heartbreaks and painful past experiences can be exhausting, but healing requires knowledge, self-discovery, and faith.

"Let's Fix" by Sinovia Mulenga is the book you need to regain hope and realign your perspective. It offers wisdom that will help you heal, recognize your worth, and reshape your relationship journey while holding onto the belief in Godly, purpose-driven unions.

Pastor Fridah Nkweto
Kingdom Family Ministries

"Let's Fix" is an inspiring and insightful book. It has taught me the importance of staying true to myself and keeping my focus on God, no matter the circumstances.

Sinovia Mulenga reminds us that God is the ultimate healer of broken hearts. No matter how damaged we or our relationships may seem, we can trust Him to restore what is lost. The book emphasizes that when we invite God into our relationships and treat others with the same love and respect we desire, we set the foundation for strong and lasting bonds.

What I love most about this book is its practical approach, it applies to all types of relationships, whether in marriage, courtship, dating, or friendships. I highly recommend it to anyone striving to improve their relationships.

Paul Simon Mdzakazi Phiri
Author, Podcaster, and Consultant

I believe in the power of mutual friendships, in giving love a second chance despite the odds, and in the communion of saints bound by the thread of love. Love is inherently a risk, yet it is the very blueprint of our existence, rooted in the image of God and extending to our relationships.

Maureen Sinovia Mulenga bravely shares her journey, reminding us that *love remains love* regardless of our experiences. Her writing is simple yet profoundly authoritative, speaking directly to the heart.

Reading *"Let's Fix,"* I found it transformative, it reshapes the way we view God, love, and relationships in a healthier light. I see her message in three essential dimensions:

1. **Love God.**
2. **Love yourself.**
3. **Love your neighbor well.**

When these are in alignment, healthy relationships follow. I encourage readers to get a copy, immerse themselves in her writing, and witness the courage and wisdom she shares. I wholeheartedly support and encourage her continued expression.

Pastor Charmaine Sakala
Faith Elevation Ministries

"Let's Fix" is an incredible book. Maureen Sinovia Mulenga dives deep into some of the most pressing relationship challenges of our time. Relationships can often feel like a puzzle, but this book provides clarity, helping readers understand their purpose and identity.

One of the most powerful themes in this book is the emphasis on Christ-like love. Sinovia beautifully conveys that true love and relationships are best understood through a deeper connection with Christ. She reminds us that love is not just about human emotions or efforts, it is about reflecting God's love in the way we treat others.

A successful relationship requires all the key elements she highlights: sacrifice, respect, commitment, understanding, faithfulness, and trust.

I thoroughly enjoyed reading this book and would love to see a *Part 2*! Give yourself a chance, give this book a chance. I hope you enjoy it as much as I did.

INTRODUCTION

Let's Fix is a book that, by God's grace, will help you reflect on your relationship life and identify the areas that need healing and growth. It is a journey toward restoration, a reminder that you are a jewel, worthy of love and wholeness.

I believe that giving up isn't always the answer. Even broken vessels can become beautiful again when placed in the right hands. There is still beauty in what seems shattered, don't throw it away just yet. God can take you, right where you are, and reshape your life into something new. He is the Potter, and if you give Him all the pieces, He can mend what's broken.

Reading this book is meant to be a point of contact for you, a moment of deep reflection, and a glimpse into the future you can build with your partner. My prayer for you, dear reader, is that God will open your eyes to what you may not have seen until now, and guide you in how to fix and perfect your relationship life. Most importantly, may this book be a point of encounter, an encounter with Jehovah, who alone can teach you how to love and how to be loved the right way.

CHAPTER ONE

LET'S FIX

Growing up, every time my flip-flops would cut, I would get a wire and place it in between to maintain balance and restore them to a usable state. This simple and burden-relieving process kept us running and saved our feet from getting sores back then. The process of fixing comes with the realization of the need for repair or the urgency to do so. In one way or another, we have all fixed something before. You might have found yourself in a similar situation, your flip-flops cut, and you are not in a position to get new ones, yet you can't discard them because you need them. I believe you resorted to fixing what was there.

According to the Oxford Dictionary, *to fix* means to fasten something securely in a particular place or position. It is the process of repairing, mending, or putting something in order or good condition.

In this book, we draw away from fixing of physical objects as we look at how we can fix what is before us but felt within us. We come to terms with the fact that the heart does not just pump blood but is also the organ responsible for creating emotions.

Follow me clearly here: the heart, physically, is an organ in the body and does not create emotions. However, it is often used as a symbol of love to describe deep inner feelings. As the Apostle Paul points out, the inner man resides deep within the heart: *"But let it be the hidden man of the heart, in that which is not corruptible, even the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God of great price" (1 Peter 3:4).*

As humans, we have been created with **a** body, soul, and spirit. Man is a spirit, who has a soul and lives in a body. The **spirit** is the real person, the part that connects to God. Our spirit is our innermost being, we communicate with God through our spirit, not our physical senses. The **soul** serves as the bridge between the spirit and the body. Within the soul reside the mind **(**our thoughts), the will (our ability to make decisions), emotions (our feelings), and personality (including character).

It is through these emotions that we are drawn to one another as human beings. However, oftentimes, our hearts have been shattered into pieces and need to be restored.

Engaging in the process of healing is essential to returning to a state of wholeness.

The healing process comes with acceptance and a deliberate move to pursue it. The scripture in psalms 51:10 which says *"Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a right spirit within me,"* is our building block for our healing and fixing. God being the creator of humanity puts him in a position to be able to fix what concerns them as he knows them well. You cannot fix something that you do not know how to fix. When the psalmist says “create in me a clean heart," he wanted to be fixed and him continuing to say "and renew a right spirit within me," shows us the hope, assurance, and ability of that fixed heart to learn new ways of doing things or retaining to a posture or condition of use. As we get fixed, it is important to know what we are fixing and why we need fixing.

- We are fixing ourselves to be perfect and ready for ourselves and our partners.
- We are fixing those gaps that we have been seeing in our relationships.

Delve into this journey with me as we work towards fixing ourselves and our relationships. With a open heart and mind, I encourage that you read and learn from what is discussed in this book.

CHAPTER TWO

AUTHOR'S PERSONAL EXPERIENCE

Just like most people, I have experienced love. My experience may be similar to yours or completely different, but either way, there's always something to learn from it. This is my journey in love.

After completing my secondary education, I was exposed to society, a world full of all kinds of people. This was beyond the structured environment of school, where our main focus was studies and having fun with friends. Now, I had to be more intentional about my choices and make decisions I had never faced before, one of which was dating.

At 19, I decided to start dating and said yes to a guy who had been interested in me for a long time. He claimed to have loved me since secondary school. He was my senior—I was in Grade 10 when he was in Grade 12. I convinced myself to give it a try, partly because I was running out of excuses to tell my friends about why I

wasn’t dating. Having completed secondary school, passed well, and seeming mature, I felt pressured to go along with it.

Dating him was a completely new experience, and it felt strange. I had admired guys while growing up, but this was different. It wasn’t like the friendships I had with male friends at school and home, where we could chat, laugh, and meet casually without any pressure. This relationship was intense, he would call me constantly, ask what I was doing, where I was, if I had eaten, and repeatedly tell me, “I love you.”

It all felt overwhelming. I wasn’t used to the constant calls or his need to see me so often. I felt uneasy, especially answering his calls in front of my family, and walking with him in public made me uncomfortable. Everything about it felt awkward, and in just two weeks, I realized I couldn’t handle it. So, I decided to end the relationship.

When I went to university in 2020, I felt so alone. The place was completely new to me. I was the only girl from my school who got accepted to study at the University of Zambia, and adjusting to this unfamiliar environment was challenging. I had moved to a new province, had never been to a boarding school, most people didn’t speak my language, and I knew practically no one I could talk to. It felt like starting over—learning to accept people as they

were and blending in with individuals from different backgrounds and even foreign students.

Within a week, I met a guy who was always there for me. He introduced me to university life and kept me company. He filled the gap of loneliness, and when he proposed to me, I agreed to date him. However, as time passed, I realized I didn't love him, I was just with him because I was lonely. Still, I continued the relationship, hoping I would grow to love him.

Unfortunately, COVID-19 broke out, and schools closed. Our relationship became long-distance, and things changed. Our communication started fading, we could go days without talking. The situation made it even harder for me to fall in love with him, and we grew apart. Eventually, I couldn't bear it anymore. I constantly felt single despite being in a relationship, so I ended it.

During that period, about a week before schools closed, I met a guy who was the perfect picture of my dream man. There was an instant connection, and we exchanged numbers. We even took pictures together, and they turned out amazing. I found myself wishing I was dating him instead of my boyfriend at the time.

Since I was already in a relationship, we started talking just as friends. But when schools closed and my boyfriend started acting distant, this guy was there for me, giving me

attention. After my breakup, I began imagining myself with him more and more. Every time his message popped up on my phone, I couldn’t help but smile.

Eventually, we started dating, and I was so happy. I had truly fallen for him, and at times, I couldn't believe I was actually with him. The first two weeks of our relationship were wonderful, it felt like a dream. Then, out of the blue, he called to tell me he was going to the farm and that we wouldn’t be able to communicate as much. I understood and only checked in with him in the mornings, leaving him to reply whenever he could.

But after that week, a whole week passed without a word from him. I started worrying, thinking maybe he didn’t have airtime since he was at the farm. So I sent him some. That’s when I got the shock of my life, he scolded me for it. I tried to comfort myself, thinking maybe it was just his pride, maybe he didn’t feel comfortable with me buying things for him. We talked it over and settled the issue but his behaviour didn’t change. He would go silent for days. Then one day, he called and told me he was going through something and needed space to sort things out. I respected that and gave him two weeks. But when I finally decided to check in and called him, he got upset again. He told me I shouldn’t have called and that we would talk when school reopened. Once again, I convinced myself to be patient and waited for the day we would meet in school.

When we finally did, everything seemed fine. He was happy and I felt relieved. But I had to rush somewhere so we didn't get to talk much. The next day, I texted him about it only to receive the most unexpected response, a breakup. All he said was that things wouldn't work out and that he wanted to focus on God.

I cried that day because I couldn't understand how I was stopping him from focusing on God. I kept wondering what I had done wrong. I begged him to at least give me back the fantasy of waiting for him, the dreams of being with him. But there was nothing I could do. It was one of the most difficult phases of my life.

I still had to see him in school, and even worse, at church for Koinonia. Many times, I would find myself sitting next to him, bleeding and hurting inside, but I couldn't change the past. So, I accepted the breakup and started moving on. Then one day, I decided to post him on my status, only to receive a message from someone claiming that he was dating their friend. Within a few minutes, the girl herself texted me and explained everything. That's when I discovered that they had been in a relationship all along. He had only come to me when they had misunderstandings, and when they got back together, he didn't know how to handle me. The truth shattered me. When I confronted him, he tried to deny it, but there was no escaping reality. It didn't end well, and for a while, we

were in constant conflict. I grieved deeply and always felt hurt.

What made it worse was the constant questioning, what was wrong with me? Why did he do this to me? Seeing the girl only made it more painful. We were course mates, and I couldn’t help but compare myself to her every time. The pain ran so deep that I never saw myself entering another relationship. Every man who approached me never made sense to me.

After my breakups, I sat down and began to think about what was wrong with me and where I was missing it all. I became depressed as I had made it my target to ensure that my relationship with my last ex worked out. I would put in a lot of effort just for the relationship to work. When we broke up, I didn't take it lightly and was willing to beg the person just to be with me. I threw away all my self-worth and dignity just so that I can keep this person. It became hard for me to move on because I was filled with pain and that affected my relationship with God. I could no longer hear God and I stopped concentrating much on him. I called myself cursed, I laughed at myself for helping my friends work out their relationships while mine kept on flopping. I even started calling myself John the Baptist (one that just prepares the way for others). I was so just lost and consumed with my situation that I

couldn't see that everything happens for a reason and that God is teaching me something.

After confiding in people and reading books like "Good Morning Holy Spirit" by Benny Inn and "Baptism Of Love" by Lief Hetland, I was finally helped and for two years I chose to stay single so that God can work on me and help me see things clearly. I decided to stay patient and try to discover myself and lean on God as I seek him wholeheartedly. By God's grace, I got on my feet and saw a future worth fighting for.

Here we are today, I have accepted everything, I have encountered God, I have discovered myself, and I know that there is nothing wrong with me. I have faced my fears and found purpose, I know there is much I can do and I know that I am loved and that in times when I am a **Mess** Christ is **Messiah;** he comes and lets me be identified in him. He takes away all the mess and makes us a new creation.

This much I have learned and I know that you also have it in you to pull through because God cannot allow things to happen to us if we are not going to handle them.

CHAPTER THREE

GOD'S VIEW OF RELATIONSHIPS

There are certain things that God has kept a mystery to humankind. However, there are also things that He reveals to us through the Holy Spirit. Dating has no direct instruction from God on how it should be done but is part of what God intended to be. Mr Nelson Longesha in his book *"The unspoken sides of modern day dating"* addresses the question "Is There a Scripture on Dating? In his response, he quotes and explains Proverbs 3:5-6: in all your ways submit to Him. Other versions put it this way, "in whatever you do, acknowledge Him." He explains that "Whatever" includes dating. That implies God expects His people to have a clear understanding of what is expected of them in relationships in order to bring glory to Him.

In this chapter, we explore God's nature and build on that foundation to understand His mind and will for us in relationships. God is the author of all creation. He is love and made us in His nature to love one another.

1 John 4:8 *Whoever does not love does not know God because God is love.*

We understand that God created us in His image, an image of love. If we are a reflection of love, then we are also meant to embody love. This means we cannot truly claim to know God if we do not have love.

God sees love as a beautiful thing and encourages us to live in it.

John 15:12 *My command is this Love each other as I have loved you.*

The love He has shown us is the same love He expects us to show one another. This command provides direction on how God wants us to love just as He loves us. He calls us to be like Him and to imitate His way of loving as written in the book of Ephesians.

Ephesians 5:24 *Now as the church submits to Christ, so also wives should submit to their husbands in everything.* Ephesians 5:25 *Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her.*

Ephesians 5:26 *to make her holy, cleansing her by the washing with water through the word,*

Ephesians 5:27 *and to present her to himself as a radiant church, without stain or wrinkle or any other blemish, but holy and blameless.*

Ephesians 5:28 *In this same way, husbands ought to love their wives as their own bodies. He who loves his wife loves himself.*

Ephesians 5:29 *After all, no one ever hated their own body, but they feed and care for their body, just as Christ does the church.*

Love just as Christ loves the church. His love for us is so amazing that he never wants us to suffer. His will for us is for us to love like him. He has given us a heart of love and continues to show us the right way to love. In the book of Philippians 2:5, he guides us on how to love. This love is shown in him, we have to be like him to experience genuine love and know the right way to love.

NIV PHILIPPIANS 2:5 IN YOUR RELATIONSHIPS WITH ONE ANOTHER HAVE THE SAME MINDSET AS CHRIST JESUS

We have to understand the mindset of Jesus Christ for us to love like him and have the same mindset as him. We have to know who Christ is and what kind of a person he is. What is this way of loving?

Christ Sacrificed Himself For Us

The Bible tells us what love is through what God did. True love is seen in our sacrifice (Romans 5:8 But God demonstrates his love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us). God gave his only son to show how much he loved us.

From my experience, you can see that I was not willing to leave my comfort zone in my first relationship. I failed to sacrifice so that the relationship could work out, but God views love as a sacrifice. I can give a practical example of those who are dating and in a long-distance relationship. You will find that for their relationship to work out, they have to sacrifice their time and money. If they are not visiting each other, they will buy enough airtime to have video calls. It is their love for each other that makes one move from a far distance, like Lusaka, just to go and see their partner in Kasama.

From my second relationship experience, it was the lack of sacrifice in communication during the long-distance phase that made us grow apart. It became difficult for me to know my partner more because we would only talk once or twice a week. We both became too overwhelmed with the pandemic and our lives that we could not sacrifice to invest in the relationship.

Sacrifice in a relationship involves being there for your partner just as Christ is always there for us. You create time for them because they are dear to you.

Christ Is Forgiving

Going back to the Garden of Eden, man sinned against God, but God did not hold that against man. Out of His love for mankind, He couldn't let him perish and had to stay connected with him. He did something amazing—He didn't wait for man to say sorry; He just forgave him. That's how we should love. We have to understand that misunderstandings will come about, but holding onto them will only keep us distant from each other.

Ephesians 4:32 says, *Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other, just as in Christ God forgave you.*

1 John 2:10-11 says, *Anyone who loves their brother and sister lives in the light, and there is nothing in them to make them stumble. But anyone who hates a brother or sister is in the darkness and walks around in the darkness. They do not know where they are going, because the darkness has blinded them.*

Christ Jesus is the light of this world, and He is God who is love. So when we walk in darkness and hate each other, we are not living in love and are not showing love as Christ has commanded us to. A walk with someone you hate is not enjoyable and can lead to an early demise. You have to continuously forgive each other to have a thriving relationship. Mistakes and misunderstandings will always arise where people are involved, but we must understand that we are not perfect and learn to forgive each other. As Mr. Nelson Longesha puts it in *Modern Day Dating*, *"There is no love without mercy."* Every time we forgive, we exercise the act of love.

Christ Is Humble and Has Respect For Everyone

The humbleness of Christ surpasses all that we can think of. Here is a Man who is God, who has a throne, is a king, and is praised throughout by the angels, yet He never let His nature and titles define His way of life. Philippians 2:6 says, *Who, being in very nature God, did not consider equality with God something to be used to His advantage;* Philippians 2:7 *rather, He made Himself nothing by taking the very nature of a servant, being made in human likeness.* Philippians 2:8 *and being found in appearance as a man, He humbled Himself by becoming obedient to death — even death on a cross!* He lived His life full of

respect and humbleness, even though He was insulted and beaten.

Our lives should be like that of Christ. We ought to be humble and have respect in our relationships. We don't know who will need whom in the future. A "know-it-all" person is often given distance by people. They are not exposed to personal development because they only have themselves to learn from. Their pride drives away others, and they are not submissive to correction. Being humble and respectful brings great rewards. Let's consider the relationship with our parents. The Bible tells us about the reward that comes with obeying our parents: Ephesians 6:1 says, *Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right.* Ephesians 6:2 *"Honor your father and mother"—which is the first commandment with a promise—* Ephesians 6:3 *"so that it may go well with you and that you may enjoy long life on the earth."*

Through your humility, you are creating a soft spot in the hearts of the people you are in a relationship with, whether they are your parents or your partner. Love sees no status, whether rich or poor; it will flow if it's meant to be. In our relationships, we have to see beyond the status of our partner, and we have to respect them even when we hold a higher status than them. As Kathryn Kuhlman said, *"Where there is real love, there is humility."*

Christ Is Faithful

We see Christ fulfilling his promise even when it was hard for him, he wished for the cup to pass him (NIV, St. Luke 22:*42 "Father, if you are willing, take this cup from me; yet not my will, but yours be done.").* He stays true to his words and he does not lie. He does not just say things but carry out actions; cannot promise something and end up not doing it. He finishes what he has began. Being faithful in our relationships entails us being loyal in the relationship, we can't say this today and refuse to have said it the next day. God is faithful, he has always been true to his words and he expects us to be faithful. Being faithful helps us to be true to ourselves and our partners. It shows how considerate we are, and the respect we have for them.

Commitment

Throughout his ministry, Christ was dedicated to fulfilling his father's business (St. John 6:38 For I have come down from heaven not to do my will but to do the will of him who sent me). Christ stayed devoted to his assignment. He could have given up in the garden of Gethsemane but he chose to stay committed till he fulfils his purpose. Commitment entails being dedicated, devoted, or pledged to a particular course of action, goal, or relationship. It

implies a strong sense of responsibility, loyalty, and perseverance. Commitment is very important in a relationship, we need to be willing to work things together, overcome challenges, and maintain the bond over time. We have to stick to our decision and fulfill our part in the the relationship.

In all your relations, have the same mindset as Christ Jesus. Think like Christ and do things the way Christ would do them. He has set the best example of how to show love and keep relationships. Despite being here on earth, he stayed faithful with God the father and continuously communicated with God in heaven.

CHAPTER FOUR

STEPS TO TAKE BEFORE ENTERING INTO A RELATIONSHIP

We understand that humans have been created in such a way that they can relate. In that relation, we understand that when a girl and a boy become of age, they develop feelings which include sexual feelings. They tend to get attracted to what they see. God created man and woman with such feelings and considering the virtue of creation, man and woman can marry. God created Adam and Eve and told them to multiply (Genesis 1:27 So God created mankind in his image, in the image of God he created them; male and female he created them. Genesis 1:28 God blessed them and said to them, "*Be fruitful and increase in number; fill the earth and subdue it. Rule over the fish in the sea and the birds in the sky and over every living creature that moves on the ground)*. It is a system designed by God and it naturally occurs. As John Eldredge puts it in 'Love and War' "There is no place like marriage for those desires that God set in our hearts back in Eden, for battle, beauty, and a shared adventure; the desire for intimacy, companionship, and love— to come true." We can not run away from it and the bible clearly

tells us that it is better to marry than burn with passion (1 Corinthians 7:9).

With this growth and change comes the call to marriage between a man and a woman, but with this call comes great responsibility. Our journey to marriage is full of duties and responsibilities that we can't just enter into with anyone. We must choose a partner with whom we will grow and walk the Christian journey of marriage. Below are some steps we can take if we feel ready to settle with a partner, helping us make the right decision and build a strong relationship.

Am I Ready To Date

The zeal to be with someone special who thinks am also special can be incredibly strong. Dating can be defined as any social activity in which your romantic interest is focused on one particular person. It is a stage of romantic relationships in which two individuals engage in activities to evaluate each other's suitability as a partner in a future intimate relationship. Mr Alex Okello in his *book '7 Steps to find a soulmate'* defines dating as a period when you feel ready to open up your mind, heart, and soul for relationship, a time when you evaluate those who God places in your space or environment. Dating helps a man and a woman determine if they will marry. When you date

someone, you are affecting the other person's feelings. It is therefore important to know why one wants to engage in this activity and if they are fully ready for it. From my experience, I engaged into something I was not ready for and because I was not ready for it, I could not handle it and it could not work out. So be sure that your intentions are honorable before engaging yourself in it. You have to be ready before you engage in it.

My Ideal Partner

After evaluating yourself and concluding that you are ready to date, you now look within your preferences for a partner. Have a clear picture of the person you want to date. Make a list of the character; qualities and attributes that you want your partner to possess. This becomes a guide to the kind of people you allow in your space. The list of qualities should be those things that are dear to you, those that match your faith, your vision, or what you believe in. The qualities should be something that you would like your future spouse to have. After you have a clear list, start praying for the person who will have those qualities. In your journey, you may or might not meet the person with all the qualities but ensure to go for the person with the most important qualities from the list.

Love

Love is the greatest key to a strong relationship. Without love, a relationship cannot be pure and is likely not to go anywhere. According to John 3:16 (For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life.) It is because of love that we came to be saved. If God did not love us, he would have let us perish. If I don't love my partner, I can not do good to them. Love creates an atmosphere of sacrifice. Love should be the basis of every relationship. We should love the person we are walking with on this journey to marriage. Let's not just date because they are nice but because we love them despite their flaws. It's love that fights the flaws. For example, dating because she is beautiful, slim, and has a nice body. What if she grows old, gains weight from childbirth and her body gets deformed, will you continue loving her? When we decide to date, knowing well what we want, we date beyond looks. The principle of LIKING BECAUSE AND LOVING DESPITE should apply. Because of this, you like them but despite them being short, you love them. As you engage in the process of dating, be willing to love the person you will be dating.

4. **Relationships:** how good are you at keeping relations? How long do your relationships with friends last? What kind of relationship do you share with your family? These

questions should roam around your mind to help you know how you will keep your relationship based on your other relations. People often neglect to look at the upbringing of someone but our childhood has a great effect on our future. How we have grown up to relate with our family; our parents, siblings, and friends is likely to be the way we will treat our spouse and children so we are to ensure that we keep our relations and treat every relationship with respect.

Do Your Assignment

Before you say yes and start the relationship, do your assignment well. Your assignment is consulting inorder to know more about the person. The first person and right person to consult is God, ask God about this person. Pray to God and know his opinion over this relationship you want to engage in. As you continue praying to God, do a background checkup on a person. It can be through social media or asking him/her questions that will help you know them more. Through your interactions with the person, hear of their views on certain matters that are important to you and get to know even the smallest details about them. You don't get to be in a relationship with just anyone so ensure to weigh the person before you enter in that relationship.

CHAPTER FIVE

WHAT TO LOOK OUT FOR IN A RELATIONSHIP

Relationship with God

Where have you put God in your life? Have you acknowledged God, and is He at the center of your relationship? Having God in your relationship sets a firm foundation for your home and gives direction in which you should move. It makes the parenting ministry easy and assures prosperity in all that you do. Psalms 55:22 says, *"Cast your cares on the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken."* If you cast all your challenges and problems faced in your relationship to God, He is faithful to walk with you and help sustain you during the challenges. A home where God is involved prospers because you are not fighting alone and neither are you leaning on your own understanding. God is fighting with you and guiding you through the journey. Isaiah 48:17 says, *"This is what the LORD says—your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel: I am*

the LORD your God, who teaches you what is best for you, who directs you in the way you should go."

So, you should ensure that God always comes first in your relationship. A partner who draws you away from the presence of God should be given space. Your partner should help you grow spiritually and not bring you down.

Is There Purpose

Dating without purpose is a very dangerous game. You need to attach purpose to dating to avoid heartaches because whether you like it or not feelings of attraction and emotions are involved when people are dating. The only channel approved by God for living with a life partner for the multiplication of humanity is marriage. Dating precedes courtship which precedes marriage, so you only date when you are searching for a marriage life partner. That's what we call dating with purpose. You need a reason to be in a relationship and your relationship should have a purpose. Two cannot walk together unless they agree. The both of you should have a common go. No one should lead to the downfall of the other but you both should aim at building each other. Lookout for that purpose in your relationship, it will help you know where you are going with the person.

Is There Us

When you are dating, pay attention to how your partner sees the future. In their speech, do they talk about a future with you or do they only talk about what they will achieve on their own? Are you included in their plans? Do they consider you when making life decisions? Every time it's "I will do this, I will be this and that and not We will do this". Know where the person has placed you in their life through their actions and plans towards you.

Are They Matured?

(1 Corinthians 13:11 When I was a child, I talked like a child, I thought like a child, I reasoned like a child. When I became a man, I put the ways of childhood behind me.)

Just as the apostle points out, as we grow, childhood behaviors should remain in our childhood. If you are in a relationship with a person who is not mature, settling with that person will be hard and misunderstandings are likely to always occur because you are not thinking at the same pace. Your partner should be mature enough and it's only then that you can have a successful relationship.

Is There Trust

Trust is part of love and is based on the openness and respect one shares with their partner? A relationship without trust can not thrive and is likely to end and always bring arguments. Trusting each other in a relationship is very important, it is not healthy to always give an ear to every word spoken about your partner by people. Take time to evaluate everything you hear and speak to your partner to find out the truth. You don't need to develop insecurities in your relationship. You need to build a bond with each other that is based on truth and love. How do you treat each other in your relationship and how does your partner react when you are away from them? Are they suspicious of you, do they trust you with anything, do they accuse you of anything, do they understand your value?

Are They Responsible

As the theory of existentialism states; human beings are responsible for the consequences that come from the choices made. The same applies to a relationship, when you make a decision and decide to engage in dating, you ought to take responsibility. How responsible are you that you can settle with someone? Are you able to defend your partner, take responsibility, and financially stable to

support yourself and your partner? See to it that your partner possess the quality of responsibility. If they are not responsible as you date, they are likely not to be responsible even in marriage.

Do We Communicate

Communication is very important in a relationship. You love that person because in the first place you were attracted to them. You can not love someone you don't know. You have to know them and continuously be attracted to them and that is attained through communication. You will only get to know each other better as you communicate so a relationship without communication is on the verge of its death. Make yourself available for your partner. Look out for the efforts your partner makes to stay connected with you. Are they making themselves available for you and striving to stay in touch?

Looking out for these and answering the questions below will help you know if your partner is the person you would like to settle with.

Woman

1. Do I know his vision or assignment?
2. Can I support it?
3. Am I a suitable helper?
4. Do I want him to be the father of my children?

Man

1. Do I know and does she know my vision or assignment?
2. Can she support it?
3. Is she a suitable help met?
4. Do I want her to be the mother of my children?

CHAPTER SIX

ARE YOU WITH THE RIGHT PARTNER

Knowing if the person we are dating is the right one for us can be one of the biggest stressors in a relationship. It's often difficult to determine who is truly meant for us. In many cases, people go with the flow, hoping for the best as they move toward marriage. Unfortunately, this approach has led to many unhappy marriages and divorce cases. It is essential to evaluate your partner and make sure they are the right fit for you before committing to marriage.

In this chapter, we will explore some of the signs highlighted by Mr. Alex Okello in his book *7 Steps to Find a Soulmate and Prepare for a Long-lasting, Enjoyable Marriage*. These signs serve as a guide to help you identify whether your partner is the right one for you. However, it's important to remember that people are different, and love is experienced in various ways. The signs discussed here may not apply to every relationship, but they can serve as a helpful framework to evaluate your relationship and envision the future you hold with your partner.

- Love is natural, you have to connect with the person naturally. You do not have to force a conversation with them.

- You think about them and mean well for them. Your intention is not to exploit them but to build yourself with them.

- You feel energized by the presence of the person whenever you meet them.

- Being with them makes you feel at home, joyful and at peace.

- You are willing to compromise with them. What they say, how they behave, or what they do to you, somehow you find ways to compromise.

- You don't hesitate about planning the future with them.

- You are totally cool traveling together, bragging about them, and showing them off to others.

Agreeing to what has been stated by Mr Alex okoye, allow me to add that trusting one's Intuition helps one to reflect on oneself; how you feel about this person and who you get to be when with this person. Often, your intuition can

provide insight into whether the relationship feels right or not. To know if the person you are dating is the right partner, start by knowing yourself, understanding the nature of your relationship, how you relate with each other, and how you handle issues together.

CHAPTER SEVEN

RESTING ON GOD'S PROMISES

Rest can be defined as peace; freedom from worry, anxiety, and annoyances that disturb our state of mind. Resting on God's promises comes with total trust in God, knowing who God is and coming to understand that He is in control. Having rest in God puts us in an assurance state; we are assured of getting all the promises God has made to us. Our rest begins with us believing in God. We cannot have the rest if we do not believe Him. His promises will mean nothing, and there will be no need to have hope of seeing them fulfilled without faith in God. (Amplified Bible, Hebrews 11:6: *"But without faith it is impossible to [walk with God and] please Him, for whoever comes [near] to God must [necessarily] believe that God exists and that He rewards those who [earnestly and diligently] seek Him."*) With the belief in His existence, we begin to believe in His words. Having rest in God becomes our trust and faith in Him.

We begin to live stress-free because we know that God is faithful, he keeps his promises, and his promises are yes and amen (Amplified Bible 1 Corinthians 1:9 God is

faithful [He is reliable, trustworthy and ever true to His promise—He can be depended on], and through Him, you were called into fellowship with His Son, Jesus Christ our Lord).

At the beginning of creation, God intended rest for us. He created man and established him in the garden. Rest was given on account of God's words—it is staying in the position God has placed you, dwelling and settling in His presence.

Amplified Bible Genesis 2:15-17*: So the Lord God took the man [He had made] and settled him in the Garden of Eden to cultivate and keep it. And the Lord God commanded the man, saying, "You may freely (unconditionally) eat [the fruit] from every tree of the garden; but [only] from the tree of the knowledge (recognition) of good and evil you shall not eat, otherwise on the day that you eat from it, you shall most certainly die [because of your disobedience]."*

Provision was made for man, God gave him all that he needed and provided a dwelling place where he could rest.

The disobedience of eating from the forbidden tree made him lose the rest he had. The things he enjoyed and received freely now became things he had to stress and toil for.

Amplified Bible Genesis 3:17*: Then to Adam the Lord God said, "Because you have listened [attentively] to the voice of your wife, and have eaten [fruit] from the tree about which I commanded you, saying, 'You shall not eat of it'; The ground is [now] under a curse because of you; In sorrow and toil, you shall eat [the fruit] of it all the days of your life."*

God had given everything for free when He placed man in the garden, but now he had to work hard to get it. We can only attain true rest if we are in the presence of God and remain in the position He has placed us. The moment we start doing things our own way, we expose ourselves to energy-draining efforts for things we could have received freely, without shedding a drop of sweat.

Christ was brought to earth, fellowshipped with man, and showed man how to live on earth. He showed us how to rest on the promises of God, he showed us how to live in our identity as God's children. As the second Adam, he abided in his position as the son of God and remained in the provision God had made available.

Amplified Bible Matthew 8:23-27*: When He got into the boat, His disciples followed Him. Suddenly, a violent storm arose on the sea, so that the boat was covered by*

the waves, but Jesus was sleeping. The disciples went and woke Him, saying, "Lord, save us! We are going to die!"

He said to them, "Why are you afraid, you men of little faith?" Then He got up, rebuked the winds and the sea, and at once there was a great and wonderful calm, a perfect peacefulness. The men were amazed and asked, "What kind of man is this, that even the winds and the sea obey Him?" The storm was almost sweeping them away, yet Christ was fast asleep. He slept because He was resting on the promises of God. He understood what God had spoken and fully believed in Him. There was no need to worry because He knew He would pass through the storm unharmed.

As it is written in Isaiah 43:2 (Amplified Bible): *"When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; And through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched, Nor will the flame burn you."* Christ rested on these words because He knew the God He served, a God who never lies, a God who is faithful beyond measure, a miracle-working God, and a God whose words will always come to pass.

As it is written in Deuteronomy 7:9 (Amplified Bible): *"Therefore, know [without any doubt] and understand that the Lord your God, He is God, the faithful God, who*

is keeping His covenant and His [steadfast] lovingkindness to a thousand generations with those who love Him and keep His commandments."

Even in our relationships, God wants us to rest on His promises. He created marriage for us to enjoy, and He continues to guide us toward prosperity, showing us how to partake in the fruits of His labour. All we need to do is believe in Him and the promises He has spoken over our lives.

He assures us in His Word:

John 16:33 – "*I have told you these things, so that in me you may have peace. In this world you will have trouble. But take heart! I have overcome the world."*

Genesis 12:2 – *"I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing."*

Romans 8:28 – *"And we know that in all things God works for the good of those who love Him, who have been called according to His purpose."*

So, my dear reader, trust in God and rest in the promises He has made to you.

CHAPTER EIGHT

OTHER PEOPLE'S EXPERIENCE

In writing this book, I felt it wise not to rely solely on my own knowledge but also to learn from others. I took the time to interview married individuals to understand their experiences, how they found marriage, as well as what their dating lives were like before meeting their partners.

With their consent, I share their stories so that we can gain valuable insights to strengthen our own relationships. Their experiences will help us identify key areas in our relationship journeys by examining what worked for them, how they navigated challenges, and the mistakes we can avoid today.

For privacy reasons, I will keep their identities confidential.

Participant Number One

Before I met my husband, I was in an unstable relationship. It was more toxic than healthy, which made my dating experience quite a challenge. It wasn't all bad at first, but the bad outweighed the good. It drained me more than it built me up. The funny thing is, I didn't give up on it. I chose to hold on to something that was falling apart, hoping to mend the broken pieces. As a result, my efforts led me into depression. I became more drained each day, and by the time I realized how deep I had fallen, the pit felt so deep that all I could see was how far down I had gone. I was depressed beyond measure and struggled with self-confidence for a while.

One day, I decided I wanted something better. I wanted something different, something worth holding on to. That's when I began climbing back up from the pit I had fallen into. Bit by bit, I held onto the rope and pushed myself up. During this process of rebuilding myself, I met the man I call my husband today.

When I first met him, I had no intentions of marriage. I wanted it, yes, but at the time, I was focused on healing, so marriage wasn't at the forefront of my mind. The more time we spent together, the more I felt alive around him, and it was unexplainable. It might sound cliché, but I had met a few men before him, and none of them sparked the

way he did. So when I say he made me feel alive, I truly mean it. For some reason, we sparked something in each other, and our dating journey began.

The more we got to know each other, the more I was healing and figuring things out. But it wasn't always smooth sailing, as I had to unlearn the toxic patterns from my past relationship and adapt to what we had. What we shared was healthy, God-cantered, and full of worth. We fell deeply in love with each other, and the only thing we wanted was to be together, that's when marriage came into the picture.

Truthfully, there's no such thing as "just knowing" who the right one is, because if we did, finding our partners wouldn't be such a struggle. It's only through God that we are able to know, as He brings it to our awareness. I thank the Lord that He made this possible for me. But here's where it gets interesting. Even though we felt complete with each other, we still had to seek God's guidance to know if we were right for each other and if it was His will for us to be together. Some of you might be wondering why we involved God, but it's important because God is our source of life. Without Him, life has no meaning or purpose. A life without God lacks value unless He is at the centre of it.

In marriage, God must be the centre. With Him, your marriage has purpose. It's because of purpose that I have my husband today, and it's because of purpose that our marriage stands strong and thrives. There's so much more to marriage than beauty and pleasure, and that something is purpose. Find purpose together and serve God together.

Participant Number Two

Before I met my husband, I was dating a guy who made my relationship a struggle. It was a very bad relationship. He was selfish, sarcastic, stingy, and manipulative. The worst part was that communication was terrible. Whenever I confronted him, he would give me excuses that didn't even make sense, but they seemed to work because I thought I would never find someone as handsome and financially stable as he was. He knew I wouldn't leave him, so he took advantage of that.

Finally, I found the strength to leave him for good. He thought I'd come back like I always did after he made a mistake, but this time, I stood by my decision because I knew I deserved better.

At the time I met my husband, I was single, but I was scared to get into another relationship because of my past

experience. We started as friends, and it was hard for me to accept his proposal. But as time went by, we began dating.

When we started dating, he did everything to make me happy. He was caring, romantic, and would call me ten times a day. Despite this, I doubted him. I thought he was just another guy trying to win my affection, only to disrespect me later on. But he wasn't like that, he was serious. According to him, he was looking for a partner, and the first day he saw me, he felt I was the one.

A year later, he proposed, and he remained the same loving and caring man. You might be wondering if we ever had fights. Of course, we did. But we would talk about it and move past everything.

My advice to you is to always trust in God and never let fear control you. Just as we all have different faces, we are not all the same. You will meet someone who will cherish you and treat you the way you deserve.

Participant Number Three

I started dating my husband on December 25, 2011. We met in the praise team at church, where we were both praise singers. It was my first time seeing him, as he

wasn't living in Ndola. My husband was my first boyfriend and my first love. We dated for three years before I attended a cell meeting where I received a prophecy that the guy I was dating was not meant for me.

Because I deeply love and believe in God, and I respect prophecy, I made the painful decision to break up with him. I didn't want to disobey God. After that, I met another man, and we dated for a year before getting married. Unfortunately, that marriage didn't work out, and we were only together for two years before divorcing.

After the divorce, I decided to go back to school, but during that time, my first love came back into my life. Two years after my divorce, we got back together, but my parents didn't approve of our relationship. They thought he was the reason my first marriage didn't last. Despite their disapproval, we never gave up on each other. I continued seeing him secretly for three years until I completed school, and then he decided to propose.

Once my parents found out about the engagement, they accepted him, and now we are happily married. I'm truly happy in this marriage because I know I've married my best friend—the person who has never judged me and has accepted me for who I am.

To anyone out there still searching for love: you may have an image of who you want to marry, or you may have

received a prophecy about your future partner. It's not wrong to believe in prophecy or to have expectations, but as the Bible says, "test every spirit." You might let go of what's meant for you because you're holding on to certain beliefs that are blocking you from seeing what's right in front of you.

Never give up on love, trust the process. what is meant for you will find its way to you. And lastly, don't think it's all over when things don't go well. Find the strength to move on, become a better version of yourself, and don't be weighed down by life's challenges.

Participant Number Four

Dating for me was challenging. I went through a lot, and many people couldn't go through the process with me. It felt like there were always differing perspectives between us. I would share my vision and plans, but the other person wouldn't agree. It was like we were two different people with completely different agendas.

I once dated someone with whom I had many reasons to be together, but she needed too much attention. It became very difficult to meet her expectations because I had so many other things to focus on. Eventually, I realized I was

hurting her by not being able to give her the attention she needed, so we decided to part ways.

Then, I met my wife, and she showed me a level of maturity I hadn't experienced before. She was understanding, and we agreed on many things. She was exactly what I had been waiting for, she behaved and acted the way I had hoped a woman would. Of course, we didn't always agree 100%, but we made compromises and worked things out in a way that suited both of us.

The most important advice I can give to anyone still searching is this: be comfortable with the person you're with, and never settle if you have even the slightest doubt. Dating is a process of getting to know someone. Only commit when you feel that the relationship has been blessed. Don't look for love at first sight; look for understanding at first sight.

Real love begins only after you truly know someone, and that's when you decide to commit to them because you know them well. Loving someone you don't fully know can leave you hurt. When you fall in love first, and then discover how different you are from each other, it's painful. You'll feel compelled to try to change them, but people don't change that easily.

Participant Number Five

I never went through the typical dating process, as I see it as a sheer waste of time. In the act of dating, people often engage in behaviors that are not right, leading to situations that can affect their lives in the future. For instance, some may get pregnant and not end up with the person they were involved with, while others may face heartbreak that negatively impacts their future relationships. The people they encounter in these relationships aren't easily forgotten, and they often carry memories of those experiences.

What I find to be the waste of time is that people focus on searching for a partner in multiple people instead of focusing on building themselves and cultivating a connection with one person. In our tradition, the family approaches the woman's family on behalf of the man. I observed my wife from a distance and saw that she was fit to be my wife, so I notified my family to make the necessary arrangements, and we got married.

My advice to those still searching is this: dating someone to see if they're fit for you often becomes a fault-finding mission. When you look for faults, you will inevitably find them, and then you'll move on to the next person with the same mindset. Before you try to change someone, ensure that you are truly compatible and right for them.

It’s hard to change a person, but once you’re married, they are yours, and it’s easier to shape them into the partner you want.

Marriage is an institution that you shouldn’t enter into with just anyone. It’s important to truly know the person you’re considering for marriage. This requires doing your homework—observing the person and getting to know their family, because their family will also become your family.

CHAPTER NINE

AUTHOR'S ADVICE

From my experience and the experiences shared above, it’s clear that we all have different paths. Your experience might be worse than what any of us went through, but remember, we all have a past. We’ve all faced things that left us broken and impacted our lives, but we are the ones who can change our lives. The power to change begins with us, and we have the ability to do something about our past. The choice is ours.

I urge you to choose healing and move forward. You’ve cried enough—the time to move on is now. You deserve to be happy. We have inherited the gift to love from God, and we must love as He does. Giving up is not in the definition of a Christian because we are overcomers. God will never bring us something He knows we can’t handle. You are very much capable of handling it. You can pull through anything because greater is He that is in you than the thoughts of failure that may consume you.

Exodus 14:15 says, “Then the LORD said to Moses, 'Why are you crying out to me? Tell the Israelites to move on.'”

Crying won't solve the problem. I am telling you to move on and do something about your life. You are destined for greatness. Experiencing problems does not mean that God is not with you. Even Jesus Christ, who is God, was in the boat with His disciples when the storm almost swept them away. God is in the story. Change your focus and begin to rest on His promises. It is well.

Declare these words into your life: "Surely, goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life. I will dwell in the house of the Lord forever, and I will testify of the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living."

Prayer

Almighty Lord, I come to you as I am. With all my pain, I come. I trust in you, I know you are working out things for my good. You know me and you know what is best for me. May your will be done in my life. Help me to have faith that I may rest on your promises. Ephesians 3:14 For this reason I kneel before the Father, Ephesians 3:15 from whom every family in heaven and on earth derives its name. Ephesians 3:16 I pray that out of his glorious riches he may strengthen you with power through his Spirit in your inner being, Ephesians 3:17 so that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. And I pray that you, being rooted and established in love, Ephesians 3:18 may have power, together with all the Lord's holy people, to grasp how wide and long and high and deep is the love of Christ, Ephesians 3:19 and to know this love that surpasses knowledge —that you may be filled to the measure of all the fullness of God. Ephesians 3:20 Now to him who is able to do immeasurably more than all we ask or imagine, according to his power that is at work within us, Ephesians 3:21 to him be glory in the church and in Christ Jesus throughout all generations, for ever and ever! Amen.

About The Author

Maureen Sinovia Mulenga holds a Bachelor’s degree in Arts with Education from the University of Zambia. She is a devoted and passionate Christian with a deep love for the things of God and a strong commitment to advocating for positive change.

She is the founder of "Me and My Sisters," a Christian organization dedicated to empowering women and nurturing strong, courageous, faith-driven women who build their lives and homes on God's foundation.

Beyond her ministry, Maureen is a public speaker, entrepreneur, and content creator, using her platform to inspire and uplift others.